

The One-Library Method

Turn one photo into every ad, every size, every placement. No designer. No production team. One asset, an afternoon, a full set of statics and videos.

by Matt Holmes

The bottleneck on creative was never taste. It was that every new size meant a new project, so you shipped three ads when you needed thirty. **This is the exact system I use to turn one approved asset into a full ad set across every ratio a platform runs.** Five steps. The prompts are below, ready to paste. You run it in whatever image tool you already have, plus free Canva. No code.

1

Pick one hero asset

One clean, approved image. Product sharp, lighting right, nothing you would be embarrassed to blow up full screen. This is the only piece that has to be good. Everything after this is multiplication, not creation.

T00L: **a real product photo you already own** (beats anything generated)

2

Extend it to every ratio (never crop)

You need **1:1** for the feed, **4:5** for the feed, and **9:16** for Reels and Stories. Do not crop your hero to fit, you will cut the product or logo out of frame. Extend the canvas instead and let AI paint the background wider.

COPY THIS INTO YOUR IMAGE TOOL (WITH YOUR PHOTO)

Extend this image to a 9:16 vertical canvas. Keep the product exactly as it is: same size, same position, do not crop it or move it. Continue the existing background naturally to fill the new space. Match the lighting, color, shadows, and texture so the added area blends in with no visible edge. (Then run it again for 1:1 and 4:5.)

T00L: **Higgsfield outpaint**, or ChatGPT / Gemini image edit. Anything that edits an image you upload.

3

Drop the offer layer on top

Same hero, your message. In Canva, load the extended image as the background, then add your headline, offer, and CTA as text layers on top. Keep the words in the middle third so Stories and Reels do not crop them behind buttons. Duplicate the design, resize to each ratio, export.

T00L: **Canva** (free). No code, no designer.

4 Animate the still into a loop

A moving version of the same scene stops the scroll harder than a static. You do not reshoot anything. You animate the clean, text-free image you already extended in Step 2.

COPY THIS INTO YOUR VIDEO TOOL (WITH THE TEXT-FREE IMAGE)

Animate this image into a smooth 4-second clip. Add gentle, subtle motion to the background only: a soft drift, a slow shimmer, light movement. Keep the product perfectly still, sharp, and centered. No text, no camera shake, do not warp or distort the product. Make the first and last frame match so it loops with no visible jump.

TOOL: Seedance / Higgsfield image-to-video, or Runway, Kling, any i2v tool.

5 Overlay the offer on the video

Back in Canva, drop the clip in as the background and lay the **same** text layers from Step 3 on top. Export each ratio. Now you have the moving version of every static: same message, same look, twice the creative from the same asset.

TOOL: Canva (free) handles the video overlay too.

The 3 rules that keep it from looking AI-cheap

1 The background IS the design

A product floating on a flat color block reads as bad Canva instantly. Put it on a real, designed field, that is what the extend step is for. If the background looks cheap, the whole ad looks cheap.

2 Never crop, always extend

The fastest way to ruin a good asset is to jam it into a square and lose half the product. Extend the canvas so the hero survives every ratio untouched, then place your text in the new space.

3 Ship every ratio, keep text centered

Upload only one size and the platform auto-crops the rest, usually eating your headline. Give it 1:1, 4:5, and 9:16, and keep the words in the center band so nothing important sits under a button.

Your turn, 15 minutes

Take your single best product photo. Run Step 2 once to extend it to 9:16. Drop one offer headline on it in Canva. **That is one finished vertical ad, from an asset you already owned, in about fifteen minutes.** Then do the other two ratios. Then animate it. By the end you will have what used to be a week of production sitting in one folder.

The tools did not do this. **You did.** The AI extended the canvas and added the motion, but you picked the hero, you wrote the offer, you decided what shipped. That is the whole game. The operator points, the tool produces.

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